

Decision tree: Choosing a polygon operation

st_make_valid()

st_is_valid(reason = TRUE) names the fault; run the repair as part of reading a polygon file

then

What does the question need?

which features are involved

st_filter()

whole features, with their fields untouched

how much of a layer is inside another

st_intersection()

the geometry cut to the overlap; an area field has to be recalculated with st_area()

what each field means for its geometry

st_agr()

constant, aggregate or identity, recorded so the warning names the fields you have declared

how to put a value on a different set of polygons

st_interpolate_aw()

extensive = TRUE for a total and FALSE for a rate; assumes an even spread within each source polygon

how to reduce the file size for drawing

st_simplify()

dTolerance in the units of the CRS; shared boundaries pull apart, so simplify a copy